

A QUOTA FOR HER KINSMEN

Member of a family of BJP supporters, Roopa says the ruling party at the Centre has introduced many schemes that have helped those living in the villages. "Nobody thought about providing drinking water connections and toilets in village homes, rural electrification and direct transfer of subsidies to our accounts," she says, explaining why she supports the BJP. She is also happy that the Modi government has built the new Ram temple at Ayodhya. But she wishes that the PM in a third tenure at the Centre would help provide more jobs for rural youth and ST status for the Gurjars, ensuring more quota in jobs and education.

"So many members of our community have lost their lives in the agitation demanding more reservation for Gurjars, still we have yet to get the reservation that our next-door Meena neighbours enjoy [designated ST in Rajasthan]," she says. ■

-Rohit Parihar

Roopa Gurjar, *58*
Deoli Banas, Rajasthan, *Farmer*

Constituency: Tonk-Sawai Madhopur

Issues that will decide her vote: Welfare of women and her community

Demands from the govt: Gurjar quota like for tribal Meenas



DEBAJYOTI CHAKRABORTY

Sukanya has never missed casting her vote because she believes that it is her democratic duty to ensure a more "women-friendly world" for the future. While she is appreciative of the Women's Reservation Act, passed last year to ensure reservation of one-third seats in Lok Sabha and state assemblies for women, she believes that issues such as the Ram temple and the 2019 abrogation of Article 370 (which granted special status to Jammu and Kashmir) must never be used as poll planks.

"The country must be a better, more equal and just place for women. I must vote if I want to get this demand fulfilled"

"There is an attempt to dictate our culture, food habits, what the women should wear. I think the BJP is behind this and that should be prevented," alleged Sukanya. She is also aware of the allegations of corruption against the ruling Trinamool Congress in West Bengal, but believes that CM Mamata Banerjee's government has done enough good work. Unsure if anyone she votes for can fulfil her demands for women and democracy, she says she will vote for the best among the candidates, basing her choice on the rule of elimination—striking off those she doesn't approve of. ■

-Arkamoy Datta Majumdar